

CD vs VCD vs DVD

Q I recorded and saved a TV programme using Pinnacle PCTV, and did a bit of editing using VirtualDub. I saved the file as a .avi file, and then compressed it to Windows MPEG. After that I burnt it onto a CD. Unfortunately, the CD does not play on my Philips DVD player, but it does play on my PC. Why?

K N Prasad

A Your DVD player probably does not support MPEG videos. To view it using your DVD player, burn a VCD rather than a regular CD. Your CD-burning software will then convert the file to a VCD-compatible format. You should be able to play the VCD on any regular VCD or DVD player.

However, keep in mind that depending on your specifications of your computer, the encoding process can take quite some time.

I Changed My Mind...

Q I recently downloaded a BIOS update from Intel's Web site. But now, I would like to roll it back. I want to know if there is a way to uninstall or remove the update? I have a P4 1.7 GHz computer, and the board is an Intel D845GLLY.

Bishesh Bhatta

A It is possible to roll back your BIOS by re-flashing it with an older version. If you have saved your previous BIOS, you can simply flash it from that particular file. If you didn't save your previous BIOS, you will need to download that version of the BIOS from the manufacturer's Web site.

Please be very careful while flashing your BIOS as it can render your motherboard unusable if done incorrectly.

Old Is Gold

Q I own a P4 3 GHz CPU on an Intel motherboard. There are two 40 GB partitions on my HDD. I use Windows XP on the C drive, and Win 98 SE on the D drive. My current default OS is Windows XP, but I would like to set Windows 98 as my default boot OS.

I would also like to modify the default time for which the boot menu is displayed.

Sanjay Kapoor

A As it happens, you don't need to go into the BIOS for this. You can do this right through Windows XP, by keeping XP in control of what happens during the boot process. Boot into XP, and under My Computer>Properties, go to 'Advanced', and click on the settings button in 'Startup And Recovery'. Under the default operating system drop-down menu, you can choose the operating system you would like to boot into by default.

In the same window, you can also set the time limit for displaying the boot menu.

Rolling Back DirectX

Q I am using Windows XP with SP1. I recently installed DirectX 9.0c from the *Digit DVD*. Can I uninstall it? Or can I simply install an older version over the newer version? Will this affect my system in any way?

Raj Pratap

A It is not recommended that you roll back or uninstall DirectX, as it is closely integrated with your video drivers. Also, you will not be able to roll back to a previous version at one go. You will need to download a utility called DirectX Uninstaller, located at <http://snipurl.com/dd6y>. This lets you uninstall your DirectX version 9.0c, and if you want, you may then install an earlier version.

Spyware Blues

Q I run Windows 98 SE, and every time I open Internet Explorer, I am taken to a site called www.cursormania.com. Even while browsing, I am often taken to this page. What do I do?

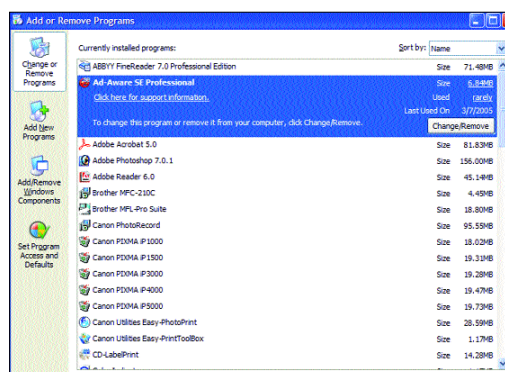
Via E-mail

A Your computer has been infected with spyware from companies such as Smiley Central. For some reason, the makers of Spybot Search and Destroy have deemed this particular piece of spyware a safe application, which means you cannot use that software to uninstall this application. You will have to remove it manually.

Go to Start>Run and type in "appwiz.cpl", which opens Add/Remove Programs. Find the application called "My Web Search (Cursor Mania)"—it should be there in the list—and then uninstall it.

Also look through the application list for programs from FunWebProducts, such as "My Web Search", "My Way Speedbar", "Search Assistant", and possibly others.

You can download HijackThis from <http://snipurl.com/dd6z>—download and run it. Also go to C:\Program Files, and delete all the folders that FunWebProducts, MyWebSearch and other similar Web sites created. This should rid you of your problem.



Programs such as MyWebSearch can get installed automatically—you can uninstall them manually